

Financially Sovereign Academy

Correctional and Reentry Program

Budgeting & Emergency Savings

Facility / Implementation Packet

Version 0.1 (provisional) · 2026-07-04

Provisional pilot-ready draft. External counsel review pending. Not for final facility distribution until legal/privacy feedback is reconciled.

Described as pilot-ready, never proven or validated. No outcome or recidivism claims.
Not legally approved. Source & Claims Ledger held at v0.2.

Facility Implementation Guide: Budgeting & Emergency Savings (v0.2)

Program: Correctional and Reentry | Version: v0.2 (implementation guide, post-audit) | Date: 2026-07-02 | Status: Needs Dalia review Supersedes v0.1 (kept as history). Applies all approved audit fixes including the mandatory High privacy fix; change list in end matter. Operationalizes the promises in the learner workbook v0.2, facilitator guide v0.2, and pre/post assessment v0.2. Written for the staff member who will coordinate the program.

The class is education, not financial, legal, tax, or credit-repair advice. Everything works on paper.

1. Program setup

Who it serves. People preparing for release, people recently released, people on probation or parole, and the facilities, reentry nonprofits, workforce programs, and supervision partners who host classes. It works even if a participant has no ID, phone, bank account, housing plan, or job. Mixed pre-release and post-release groups are supported by design (estimates track and real-numbers track on the same worksheets).

Class size. 6 to 16 works best. Up to 20 with a co-facilitator. Under 6 is workable with one adjustment that is not optional: the Session 3 warm-up uses pre-printed slips only (section 4). Fixed cohorts make pre/post matching much cleaner than open enrollment; prefer them where possible.

Room. Tables to write on. A whiteboard or flip chart helps (one worked math row uses it) but is not required. Seating that allows optional pairs without neighbors reading each other's pages.

Materials.

- Learner workbooks, one per participant (black-and-white printing is all that is needed; nothing depends on color)
- Facilitator guide (one)
- Pre/post assessment sets (one per participant, printed separately from workbooks)
- Pre-printed pressure slips for Session 3 (the slip master page ships with the print pack; see end matter)
- Local resource sheet (section 6; prepared before class)
- Pencils allowed by your facility; no scissors required (all cards tear or fold)

Technology. None. No internet, no phones, no tablets, no calculators. All math is one step at a time by hand.

Session length. Four sessions of 90 minutes, plus an optional capstone. **4 x 90 minutes is the tested default.** Any other schedule (longer combined sittings, shorter split sittings) requires a written split plan from the program before it is offered; do

not improvise splits, because the facilitator guide's timing, breather placement, and protected activities are built around the 90-minute shape.

Pre-assessment scheduling. The pre takes its own 15 minutes. Either schedule the first sitting at 105 minutes, or give the pre in a separate sitting before Session 1. Session 1 content is never cut to fit the pre.

2. Privacy and assessment handling

These rules operationalize the printed promises in the assessment. If the facility cannot honor them, the class runs without the assessment (backstop below).

- **Workbooks are never collected.** They belong to learners. The assessment is the only collected paper, and learners are told so plainly (the facilitator has a script for that moment).
- **Learner-chosen codes are the default.** No names, no ID numbers on forms. The learner picks a code only they would recognize and uses it on both sittings.
- **Nobody creates or keeps any list linking codes to names or IDs.** Not the coordinator, not the facilitator, not anyone. A forgotten code means an unmatched form; unmatched forms still count in cohort averages. That trade is accepted by design.
- **No-exception rule:** the program never shares individual assessment results with officers, supervision staff, case managers, employers, housing programs, or funders. Funders and facilities receive aggregate numbers only.
- **If your facility mandates assigned IDs on forms:** say the truth clearly. The facility may be able to connect the form to the learner. That is a residual privacy risk, and learners are told it before they write anything (the assessment contains the truthful alternate language). The program still does not share individual results, and documents and refuses individual-results requests exactly as below.
- **Request log:** every request for individual results, from anyone, is documented: who asked, date, what they requested, the response given, and whether the request was refused. Refusal is the default response. The log lives with the program contact, not at the facility.
- **Minimization principle:** no paper is beyond legal process. The program's protection is minimization: it collects as little individual information as possible, stores it for as little time as possible, and avoids names and ID numbers by default, so there is little to reach.
- **Form custody:** completed forms leave the facility with the facilitator the same day, or are stored under the written agreement (section 3). Pick one before the first class.
- **Who can access collected forms:** the facilitator and the scorer named in the MOU. Nobody else. **Correctional officers and supervision staff never handle, collect, transport, or store assessment forms, at any point, for any reason.**
- **Storage:** locked or access-controlled, per the written agreement.
- **Destruction:** assessment forms are shredded within 60 days after the post-assessment unless the MOU states otherwise. The destruction log records who destroyed them and the date.

- **Reporting is aggregate only:** cohort averages, counts, and change numbers. Never individual scores, never names or codes tied to results.
- **Backstop:** if these rules cannot be honored, do not administer the assessment. The class itself still runs.

3. MOU / partner agreement checklist (plain language, 15 items)

Put these in writing with the facility or partner before the first session. One to two pages; signatures matter more than length.

- ☐ 1. **Assessment privacy:** learner-chosen codes; no names or IDs on forms (or, if IDs are mandated, the truthful-language rule and who approved the mandate)
- ☐ 2. **No-exception results rule:** individual results are never shared with officers, supervision staff, case managers, employers, housing programs, or funders; aggregate only
- ☐ 3. **Request log:** all individual-results requests documented (who, date, what, response, refused or not); log held by the program contact
- ☐ 4. **Records requests / legal process:** if the facility receives a records request or legal process reaching any forms it holds, it notifies the program contact before producing anything; the program complies with law; learners are told at intake that legal process can reach any paper that exists
- ☐ 5. **Form custody:** same-day removal by facilitator, OR named storage location and who holds the key
- ☐ 6. **Staff access limits:** facilitator plus the named scorer only; officers and supervision staff never handle forms
- ☐ 7. **Named scorer:** the person or role (and organization) who scores; nobody else sees individual forms
- ☐ 8. **Storage and destruction:** where forms live; shredded within 60 days of the post unless stated otherwise here; destruction log (who, date)
- ☐ 9. **Step-out policy:** who accompanies the learner if security requires; whether the learner may return to the same session; who (if anyone) checks in afterward and how
- ☐ 10. **Mandatory reporting limits, if applicable:** what disclosures facility rules or law require staff to report; who explains those limits to learners, honestly, at Session 1 before the first activity, with a reminder before Session 3
- ☐ 11. **Referral handling:** who owns referrals (legal aid, benefits, health, housing); the facilitator routes, the named partner receives
- ☐ 12. **No product sales:** no financial products marketed or sold in or around the class, by anyone
- ☐ 13. **No compensated referrals:** no compensation, commission, referral fee, or benefit of any kind, to anyone, for any referral or resource-sheet listing; listings are unpaid and chosen for learner benefit only
- ☐ 14. **No advice:** the class provides no financial, legal, tax, or credit-repair advice; facility staff present in the room follow the same rule
- ☐ 15. **Local resource sheet ownership and officer presence:** who builds, verifies, and updates the resource sheet (section 6); what staff presence is required by policy and how it is disclosed to learners (section 5)

4. Classroom safety and facilitation logistics

Operational versions of the facilitator guide's rules; the coordinator makes these physically possible.

- **Pass option and no forced sharing:** the facilitator states it every session; the coordinator never asks learners afterward what they wrote or said.
- **No public dollar amounts, worksheets stay private:** room layout should not force neighbors to see each other's pages; avoid theater-style cramming.
- **Under-6 rule (not optional):** Session 3's pressure-pile warm-up uses pre-printed slips ONLY when the class is under 6. Small rooms defeat anonymity.
- **Small-room privacy:** pairs become across-the-table partners; the warm-up pile still gathers in one container; the facilitator reads slips in a flat voice and folds back anything identifying.
- **Non-writers:** pre-printed slips for the warm-up; a private scribe offer ("want me to jot while you talk?"); verbal answers count everywhere. Never announced, never singled out.
- **Mixed literacy:** every setup is read aloud; guidance pages run as read-alouds; the one math grid gets a worked row on the board; nobody is ever called on to read.
- **Pre-release vs post-release tracks:** same worksheets; estimates for pre-release, real numbers (private) for post-release. Stated at every session opening.
- **If a learner becomes upset:** quiet permission to stop writing and just listen; no attention drawn; the fictional-character option ("work it as Keisha") is always available. Session 3 is the heavy session; do not schedule it against other stressful facility events if avoidable.
- **Step-out/check-in:** stepping out is allowed without spectacle. The MOU states who accompanies the learner if security requires it, whether return to the same session is allowed, and who (if anyone) checks in afterward. Whatever the MOU says, the facilitator follows it and does not improvise.

5. Staffing

Facilitator qualifications. Comfortable leading discussion with justice-involved adults; able to hold the no-advice boundary under pressure (the facilitator guide provides verbatim scripts); trained on this module's guide before the first session. Financial-industry background is not required and does not substitute for boundary discipline.

Co-facilitator (optional, recommended above 16 learners). A co-facilitator with lived reentry experience is strongly encouraged; they model that the material is livable. Same boundary rules, same scripts.

What staff in the room should do: support logistics, protect the schedule, honor privacy rules.

What staff must not do: answer legal or case questions, give financial or product advice, look at worksheets, comment on any learner's situation, handle assessment forms (officers and supervision staff never handle, collect, transport, or store them),

or collect anything at all except per section 2.

Correctional officers / supervision staff presence. Follow facility policy. Learners speak less freely about money in front of uniformed staff; where policy allows discretion, minimize uniformed presence in the room. Where presence is required: position at the back, not circulating during writing, and the facilitator tells learners plainly what is and is not private in that room; honesty beats pretense. A learner's own supervision officer attending that learner's session should be avoided where policy allows.

Preventing the monitored feeling. Never collect or photograph worksheets; no roster annotations about what anyone said; the collection script is used at assessment time; discussion stays on scenarios and orders, never on any learner's real numbers, and staff visibly respect that line.

6. Local resource sheet (prepare before the first class)

One page, large print, black-and-white, per-facility. The workbook and scripts point at this sheet by design; class cannot launch without it. Each line needs a name, a phone number or address, and a checked date.

- ☐ Free or low-cost **legal aid** intake (civil; court-fee and debt questions)
- ☐ **Benefits office** or reentry benefits navigator (SNAP, Medicaid, reactivation questions)
- ☐ **Medication / health resource** (community health center, prescription assistance, reentry health program)
- ☐ **ID and documents help** (birth certificate ordering, state ID, fee-waiver info where it exists)
- ☐ **Workforce / job center** (and any reentry-specific employment program)
- ☐ **Transportation help** (reduced-fare programs, workforce transit assistance)
- ☐ **Credit union / CDFI / Bank On** pointer if relevant locally (pointer only; the Banking & Credit program covers accounts; no product promotion, and per the MOU, no listing is ever compensated)
- ☐ **Emergency community help line** (211-style)
- ☐ **Housing support** (transitional, emergency, rental assistance intake)
- ☐ **Supervision / payment office contact** if applicable (the "right office" for fee questions, per the class scripts)

Ownership, verification, and update cadence go in the MOU (section 3, item 15). Stale resource sheets are worse than none; verify within 60 days of each cohort.

7. Facility risk points (know these before you host)

- **Assessment privacy** is the program's most fragile promise; sections 2-3 exist because of it. The one collected paper must never become a surveillance artifact, and there is no exception to the individual-results rule.
- **Mandated IDs** convert anonymous measurement into facility-traceable records; the truthful-language rule is mandatory, learners hear it before writing, and the program's refusal-and-log discipline applies with extra care there.

- **Small classes** break warm-up anonymity; the under-6 pre-printed-slip rule is absolute.
- **The pressure-pile activity** (Session 3) is the highest privacy-mechanics moment; the facilitator runs it by script; hosts should not add observers that day.
- **Court/supervision fee questions** will come up. Staff and facilitator alike route them: the office that owns the fee, in writing, or legal aid. Nobody in the room answers them, regardless of experience.
- **Child support questions** route the same way; nothing in this class advises on support obligations.
- **Medication-cost questions** (a Session 1 shock card) route to the reentry office or case manager; the resource sheet carries the health line.
- **Curfew/supervision constraints** appear inside one Session 4 scenario; the class never speculates about any learner's conditions.
- **Fast-money product questions** ("so should I ever use a payday loan?") get the comparison frame, never a recommendation; staff do not editorialize.
- **Learner disclosures of unsafe situations** (threats, exploitation, violence): the facilitator acknowledges, does not investigate, and follows the facility's disclosure protocol and the MOU's mandatory-reporting clause. Learners hear those limits at Session 1, before the first activity, and again before Session 3.

8. Implementation timeline

Before launch (2-4 weeks out): sign the 15-item MOU; decide learner-chosen codes vs mandated IDs (and the language that follows); name the scorer; build and verify the local resource sheet; print workbooks, assessments, slips; confirm room, schedule, and the 105-minute or separate pre sitting; facilitator reviews the facilitator guide and scripts; content review copies to the facility if required.

Week of class: confirm roster and room; confirm pencil policy; co-facilitator briefed; resource sheet copies printed; assessment forms separated from workbooks; mandatory-reporting disclosure wording confirmed for Session 1.

Each session: facilitator arrives early; privacy ground rule opens every session (Session 1 also carries the mandatory-reporting limits, with a reminder before Session 3); materials counted out and back only for the assessment (workbooks stay with learners); step-out policy honored as written; after-session facilitator notes are about the class, never about named learners.

After the final session: post-assessment collected with the script; forms removed same day or stored per MOU; scored by the named scorer within 30 days; aggregate summary produced; forms shredded within 60 days of the post (destruction log: who, date); any individual-results requests logged and refused; facilitator debrief with coordinator (what worked, what to adjust, resource sheet corrections).

30/60/90-day follow-up (if applicable): the follow-up survey is a separate deliverable (not yet drafted for this module); where the facility runs one, distribution and privacy follow the same rules as the assessment; post-release follow-up goes through the reentry partner named in the MOU, never through supervision reporting channels.

9. End matter

Implementation checklist (one glance)

- ☐ 15-item MOU signed (section 3)
- ☐ Codes-vs-IDs decision made; matching language confirmed
- ☐ Scorer named
- ☐ Request log location confirmed (with program contact)
- ☐ Local resource sheet built and verified (dated within 60 days)
- ☐ Materials printed (workbooks, assessments separate, slips, resource sheets)
- ☐ Room, schedule, and pre-assessment sitting confirmed (105 minutes or separate; 4x90 default)
- ☐ Facilitator (and co-facilitator) trained on the guide and scripts
- ☐ Officer-presence, step-out, and mandatory-reporting disclosures ready for Session 1
- ☐ Form custody plan active (same-day removal or named storage)
- ☐ Scoring (30 days) and shredding (60 days) dates on the calendar
- ☐ Aggregate-only reporting understood by every stakeholder

MOU checklist

Section 3, fifteen items; print as its own page at formatting stage.

Source-needed notes

- Local resource sheet lines are per-facility and dated at build time; no national numbers are printed in this guide.
- Mandatory-reporting language is jurisdiction- and role-specific; the MOU clause is a local-fill item for facility policy or counsel. Flag for v0.5 legal review.
- Retention/destruction defaults (60-day shred) may be constrained by facility or state records policy; the MOU's stated timeline governs.
- The pre-printed pressure-slip master page is a formatting-stage deliverable; it ships with the print pack.

Unresolved risks

- **Mandatory-reporting clause needs local input;** this guide cannot write it generically; v0.5 legal review confirms the framing, including the records-request clause and the minimization language.
- **Officer-presence guidance** may be overruled by facility policy; the honest-disclosure fallback carries the weight there.
- **Follow-up survey does not exist yet** for this module; section 8's follow-up paragraph points at a deliverable still owed.
- **Observation for Program 1 (no change made):** the live Banking & Credit implementation guide allows participants to "choose or receive an ID code," the pattern rated High-risk in this module's assessment audit. Logged as a B&C maintenance follow-up for Dalia's decision; Program 1 files untouched per instructions.

- Capstone session logistics are not covered (capstone content not yet drafted).

v0.1 → v0.2 change list (all approved audit fixes)

1. **High fix:** the “single exception” structure removed; replaced with the no-exception rule (individual results never shared with officers, supervision staff, case managers, employers, housing programs, or funders).
2. Mandated-ID facilities: plain truth stated (facility may be able to connect the form to the learner; residual privacy risk; program still refuses and documents individual-results requests).
3. Request log added (who asked, date, what, response, refused or not; held by program contact).
4. Destruction: shredded within 60 days of the post unless the MOU states otherwise; destruction log (who, date).
5. Officers and supervision staff never handle, collect, transport, or store forms (sections 2 and 5).
6. Mandatory-reporting disclosure moved to Session 1 with a Session 3 reminder (sections 3, 7, 8).
7. Step-out MOU line expanded (who accompanies, same-session return, who checks in afterward).
8. “Fewer uniforms is better” replaced with outcome language (“learners speak less freely about money in front of uniformed staff; where policy allows discretion, minimize uniformed presence”).
9. No-compensated-referrals MOU item added (also noted on the resource-sheet Bank On line).
10. Minimization principle added; records-request/legal-process MOU clause added; intake honesty rule included.
11. Schedule variants removed as promises; 4x90 named the tested default; other schedules require a written split plan.
12. MOU checklist expanded from 11 to 15 numbered items.
13. Low fixes: named-scorer item; fixed-cohort preference line; slip-master deliverable note; request-log and scoring/shredding dates added to the one-glance checklist and timeline.

Proposed tracker update

See WORK-TRACKER.md rows dated 2026-07-02 (implementation guide v0.2).